

and practice. They are in nearly all particulars copied from English Orders, but to enter into detail on the various proceedings before the Master would be here inconvenient.

The Rules as they stand lay down the practice with sufficient distinctness ; and for more full information the reader is referred to that very useful work, "*Bennett's Chancery Practice in the Master's Office*," which is reprinted in the Philadelphia Law Library, and is in the hands of most practitioners ; and to the other practice books. The full statement of the practice, requiring a volume in itself to explain it fully, may be a fair reason for the writer not attempting it here. A short summary may however be useful.

There is scarcely any matter which may be made the subject of a suit in the Court, which may not become the subject of a reference to the Master. To him are referred all matters of account—questions as to priority of encumbrances—of the validity of titles in specific performance and other cases—of legacies, and their payment in administration suits—the appointment of Receivers and Guardians,—enquiries as to the estates and the maintenance and education of Minors ; and in short every subject matter which it is necessary to ascertain in order to the final settlement of the rights of parties, the Court by its Order or Decree determine that the parties have rights which entitle them to relief in the Court.

A copy of the Order or Decree having been carried into the Master's office, the warrant to consider above provided for is attended, and the Master fixes the days for bringing in the charges, claims or proposals, and proceeding with and determining the matter. The party claiming should take care to have his charge or state of facts brought in by the time appointed for that purpose ; and a party entitled to bring in a discharge may lose the benefit of it, if he delays bringing it in without sufficient reasons. The state of facts and charge, as it is commonly called, is entitled in the cause, and sets forth in short